

DIGITALAIKART ORIGINAL

THE CLAT 2027

FINAL COUNTDOWN PLAYBOOK

The 73-day sprint plan for India's toughest law entrance —
December 6, 2026, 2:00 PM

73 days to go	Dec 6 exam day (Sunday)	120 questions, 120 minutes	26 participating NLUs
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The three-phase master plan · The 73-day calendar · Five section playbooks ·
The 3:1 mock rule · The scoring math that decides your NLU · Counselling decoded

DIGITAL EDITION · 2026

Every exam fact verified against the official Consortium of NLUs website

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SOURCES AND VERIFICATION

A promise before we start

Every exam date, fee, eligibility rule, pattern detail and counselling fact in this playbook comes from the official Consortium of National Law Universities (consortiumofnlus.ac.in) or its official press releases, checked in September 2026. The study strategies are a synthesis of what has repeatedly worked for top-percentile CLAT aspirants. Where something is an estimate rather than official data, this book says so plainly.

CHAPTER 1

The 73-Day Reality Check

CLAT 2027 is on Sunday, December 6, 2026, from 2:00 to 4:00 in the afternoon. If you are reading this in late September, that gives you 73 days. Not a lot, and yet completely enough — if you spend them deliberately. This playbook is the deliberate plan.

Here is the truth most coaching institutes will not tell you upfront: CLAT does not reward the person who studied the most hours. It rewards the person who reads fastest with the fewest errors, because the paper is 120 passage-based questions in 120 minutes. You get one minute per mark, no section timers, and a penalty of 0.25 for every wrong answer. Almost everything in this book exists to serve that one constraint.

The second truth: the competition is real and growing. For CLAT 2026, the Consortium's official press release records 75,009 undergraduate applicants and 17,335 postgraduate applicants — 92,344 in total, a 17% jump over the previous year, and 96.83% of UG applicants actually showed up. Against roughly 4,000 UG seats across the NLUs (a coaching-industry estimate; the official figure varies a little by year), that is close to eighteen candidates chasing every seat. You cannot out-cram that field. You can out-prepare it.

What out-preparing means over 73 days:

- Structure beats intensity. Three phases, each with one job: build (concepts), grind (mocks), peak (taper). Chapter 4 lays them out, Chapter 5 puts dates on every week.
- Accuracy beats attempts. Chapter 13 shows the arithmetic: at CLAT's negative marking, a 70%-accurate 100 attempts scores less than an 85%-accurate 85 attempts.
- Analysis beats volume. The 3:1 rule in Chapter 12 — three hours of review for every hour of testing — is what converts mocks into marks.
- Legal Reasoning is your tie-breaker. The Consortium's official tie-break order is Legal Reasoning marks first, then age, then a computerised draw of lots.

How to use this book

Read Chapters 2 to 5 today — the exam rules, the competition, and the master plan. Then run the diagnostic described in Chapter 4 this weekend. From Monday, you live inside the calendar. The five section playbooks (Chapters 6 to 10) and the reading-speed program (Chapter 11) are your reference material: return to them every time a section underperforms in a mock. The execution chapters (12 to 17) become critical from mid-October, when mocks begin in earnest. Chapter 19 holds printable worksheets — copy them into a notebook or print them; you will use the mock log and the GK fact-sheet template every single week.

If you have not registered yet

The application window opened on August 3, 2026 and closes at 11:59 PM on October 31, 2026. The fee is Rs. 4,000 for General/OBC candidates and Rs. 3,500 for SC/ST/BPL/PwD candidates. If you have not applied, Chapter 14 walks through the form and the mistakes that get candidatures cancelled — read it before you touch the portal, not after.

CHAPTER 2

The Exam, Exactly As The Consortium Sets It

Everything in this chapter is from the official CLAT 2027 pages of the Consortium of National Law Universities. Do not revise from WhatsApp forwards or last year's screenshots — the Consortium announced in July 2026 that there is no change in syllabus or pattern for CLAT 2027, but small logistics details move every year, and this table reflects the current official position.

Item	Official position for CLAT 2027
Exam date and time	Sunday, December 6, 2026, 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM (PWD candidates: 2:00 PM to 4:40 PM)
Mode	Offline — pen and paper, OMR marking
Duration and marks	120 questions, 120 marks, 120 minutes
Marking	+1 per correct answer; -0.25 per wrong answer; 0 for unanswered
Question style	Passage-based comprehension questions, passages of roughly 450 words each, across five subject areas
Application window	August 3, 2026 (open now) to October 31, 2026, 11:59 PM
Application fee	Rs. 4,000 (General/OBC); Rs. 3,500 (SC/ST/BPL/PwD). Previous years' papers cost Rs. 500 extra
Eligibility (UG)	Passed 10+2 with 45% (40% for SC/ST/PwD). March/April 2027 board candidates eligible, evidence at admission. No age limit
Tie-break order	1) Higher Legal Aptitude/Legal Reasoning marks, 2) higher age, 3) computerised draw of lots
Participating universities	26 NLUs admit through CLAT 2027 scores
Counselling	December 2026 / January 2027 (official FAQ)
Admit card	Released on the portal; exact date intimated on the website

One logistics note that matters if you are in Tamil Nadu: the Consortium has removed Vellore and Tiruvarur from the CLAT 2027 exam-centre list. If you had picked either as a preference, log back in and update your centre choices before October 31, 2026, or the Consortium will reassign you.

The five sections and their official weightage

The Consortium publishes approximate question counts per section. These are the numbers your 73 days must be allocated against — note how 70% of the paper is reading-heavy:

Section	Questions	Share of paper
Current Affairs, including General Knowledge	28-32	about 25%
Legal Reasoning	28-32	about 25%
English Language	22-26	about 20%
Logical Reasoning	22-26	about 20%
Quantitative Techniques	10-14	about 10%

Read that table again with cold eyes. Current Affairs and Legal Reasoning together are half your paper. Quant, the section most science and commerce students instinctively drill hardest, is barely a

tenth of it. Most aspirants lose CLAT not because they are weak in any section but because they allocate their 73 days to the wrong sections. Do not be most aspirants.

What the pattern means strategically

Three consequences fall out of this structure. First, since most questions hang off a ~450-word passage, the real skill being tested is reading: the paper asks you to process several thousand words in two hours and answer 120 questions on them. Reading stamina — being as sharp on the last passage as the first — is trainable, and Chapters 6 to 9 and the reading-speed program in Chapter 11 build it.

Second, there are no section timers. You own the clock. A candidate with a fixed per-section plan beats a smarter candidate who wanders. Chapter 13 gives you the timing plan.

Third, the -0.25 penalty means every blind guess has an expected value of just +0.0625 marks — positive but almost nothing — while every careless error on a question you knew costs you 1.25 marks against a perfect attempt. Sloppiness is the most expensive habit in this exam.

CHAPTER 3

Know Your Competition

The Consortium's post-exam press release for CLAT 2026 is the most honest picture you will get of who you are up against, and it is worth internalising because it changes what a good score means.

CLAT 2026 (official)	Number
Total applications (UG + PG)	92,344
UG applications	75,009
PG applications	17,335
UG turnout	96.83% appeared (72,631 candidates)
PG turnout	92.45% appeared (16,026 candidates)
PwD candidates	548, with a dedicated nodal officer appointed
Growth over CLAT 2025	about 17% more applications
Exam centres	156 centres, 93 cities, 25 states, 4 UTs

Three things jump out. The field is nearly unanimous in showing up — 96.83% attendance means the person you are competing against is not the one who skipped. The field is growing 17% a year, so cutoffs drift upward. And the exam is administered at serious scale, which is why logistics errors (centre choices, category certificates, name mismatches) quietly kill thousands of candidatures every year — Chapter 14 is entirely about not becoming one of them.

Against this field, roughly 4,000 UG seats exist across the NLUs (a widely used coaching estimate — the exact number shifts each year as universities add seats). That is close to 18 aspirants per UG seat. The top three or four NLUs take only a few hundred students each, so the real fight is for a few thousand ranks at the top of a 72,000-strong field: roughly the top 5%.

What this means for your 73 days

You cannot prepare for CLAT in general. You are preparing to land in the top slice of a very large, very committed field. That has a specific shape: the top slice is made of candidates who (a) finish or nearly finish the paper, (b) keep accuracy above 80%, and (c) almost never lose marks on logistics. Every chapter that follows attacks one of those three. The marks themselves are decided by one number you control — accuracy on attempts — which is why Chapter 13 comes before any heroic study advice. Know the scoring math first, then earn it.

A note on cutoffs

This playbook deliberately does not quote last year's closing ranks or marks. They move every year with paper difficulty, applicant growth and seat changes, and quoting them manufactures false targets. The official counselling allotment lists on the Consortium website are the only reliable record, and even they describe the past, not CLAT 2027. Aim to maximise your score, not to chase a number you heard in a Telegram group.

CHAPTER 4

Three Phases: Foundation, Mocks, Taper

Seventy-three days is exactly the right length for three phases — but only if each phase does its one job and hands over to the next. Build for about four weeks, grind for five, peak for two. The dates below assume a September 24 start; if you are starting later, compress Phase 1, never Phase 3. Chapter 5 then puts a plan on every single week.

Phase	Dates (2026)	Days left	The one job
1. Foundation	Sept 24 - Oct 18	73 to 49	Diagnose, rebuild concepts, fix reading speed
2. Mock grind	Oct 19 - Nov 21	48 to 15	Ten full mocks, each fully analysed under the 3:1 rule
3. Peak and taper	Nov 22 - Dec 5	14 to 1	Compress revision, fix the clock, arrive fresh
Exam	Dec 6 (Sunday)	0	120 questions, 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM

Phase 1 — Foundation (September 24 to October 18)

Phase 1 has three deliverables: a diagnostic score you will use as your baseline, a daily rhythm you can sustain for ten weeks, and the rebuilding of any section that is genuinely weak.

- Days 73-71: take one full previous-year paper (the Consortium sells official past papers for Rs. 500 as an add-on to the application) under strict 2-hour conditions. Score it section by section. This is your baseline and your reality check.
- Days 70-49 daily template: 60 minutes on your weakest two sections (alternating emphasis across the week), 45 minutes of Current Affairs, 30 minutes of reading practice, plus one 25-minute Quant set every other day. Total: about 3 hours on a school or college day, 4.5 on weekends.
- Reading practice is not optional: two ~450-word editorials daily (The Hindu or Indian Express leader pages), read once at normal speed with a three-line written summary afterwards. You are training the exact skill the paper tests.
- Phase 1 exit test (October 17-18): retake a full paper. You should see a clear section-wise lift from your diagnostic. If one section has not moved, that is your Phase 2 priority.

Phase 2 — The mock grind (October 19 to November 21)

Phase 2 is where CLATs are won. Ten full mocks in five weeks — one every third or fourth day — each followed by the 3:1 analysis protocol from Chapter 12. The rhythm matters more than the mock brand: use any reputed series, but fix the same slot each time (2:00 to 4:00 PM, the real exam slot) so your brain learns that afternoons are for CLAT.

- Mock days: full paper at 2:00 PM sharp, on an OMR-style sheet if you have one, no pauses. Evening off after the attempt — you have earned it.
- The two days after each mock: the full 3:1 analysis (Chapter 12). This is the actual studying; the mock only generates the data.
- Between mocks: targeted drills on whatever the last analysis exposed. No new GK sources after November 1 — consolidate what you have.
- By Mock 8 (around November 14) your attempt count and accuracy should both have plateaued. If they have, Phase 2 has done its job. If not, use the taper to fix process problems (timing, question selection), not knowledge problems.

Mock	Target window	Milestone to hit before it
Mock 1-2	Oct 19 - Oct 25	Baseline established in Phase 1
Mock 3-4	Oct 26 - Nov 1	Attempting 100+ questions; accuracy above 70%
Mock 5-6	Nov 2 - Nov 8	Accuracy above 78%; a fixed section order you no longer change
Mock 7-8	Nov 9 - Nov 14	Attempt and accuracy both stable; weekly GK revision cycle running
Mock 9-10	Nov 15 - Nov 21	Scores within a narrow band — that band is your honest expected range

Phase 3 — Peak and taper (November 22 to December 5)

Tapering is not slowing down; it is compressing. Your last two weeks exist to make sure everything already inside your head is retrievable at 2:00 PM on December 6, and that your body clock is awake, fed and peaked for an afternoon exam. Chapter 16 gives the day-by-day plan; the principles:

- No new material after November 28. Revision only: your GK notes, your error log, your cards of legal principles.
- Two light mocks in the final week purely to keep the rhythm — timing and question selection, not scores.
- Sleep shifts by mid-November so that 1:00 to 4:00 PM is a fully alert window. The exam starts at 2:00 PM; most students who study late into the night are at their sleepest at exactly that hour.
- Logistics locked by December 1: admit card printed (two copies), centre route travelled once, pens tested, photo ID kept ready.

CHAPTER 5

The 73-Day Calendar, Week By Week

This is the plan on one page per fortnight — what to do, what 'done' looks like, and the one thing that most often goes wrong. Paste the current week somewhere you will see daily. If you fall behind, do not compress later weeks; cut the lowest-yield item in the current week and move on.

We ek	Dates	Focus	'Done' means	The usual failure
1	Sep 24-30	Diagnostic + English & Legal drills begin	One full paper scored section-wise; daily template running 6 of 7 days	Taking the diagnostic casually — untimed, interrupted. It is worthless then.
2	Oct 1-7	GK first pass (Jan-Jun 2026); Legal principle drills	GK compilation read once; 100+ legal questions solved	Reading GK passively with no notes. Start the weekly fact sheet now.
3	Oct 8-14	Logical & Quant start; English speed work	Baseline reading speed measured; 300+ total questions this week	Skipping Quant out of fear. One set every other day — small but non-negotiable.
4	Oct 15-18	Phase 1 exit test; registration finished	Exit paper shows section lift; application submitted, fee paid	Leaving registration to the last week. Submit before October 20.
5	Oct 19-25	Mocks 1-2 + full analysis cycles	Two attempts, two complete 3:1 analyses, error log seeded	Checking answers without re-solving. The autopsy is the studying.
6	Oct 26-Nov 1	Mocks 3-4; GK turns revision-only Nov 1	Accuracy crosses 70%; attempts cross 100	Changing section order mock to mock. Lock it by Mock 5.
7	Nov 2-8	Mocks 5-6; drill week on weakest section	Accuracy crosses 78%; fixed clock holds under pressure	Drilling everything evenly instead of the weakest section.
8	Nov 9-14	Mocks 7-8; sleep shift begins	Plateau visible in the data; GK sheets in second revision	Panic at plateau. A flat curve at a high level is success, not failure.
9	Nov 15-21	Mocks 9-10; full GK revision pass 1	Honest score band established; error log re-solve begun	One more mock instead of analysis. Analysis beats volume, always.
10	Nov 22-28	Revision compress; light sectional tests	All GK sheets revised once; no new material after Nov 28	Buying new GK compilations. Use your own sheets.
11	Nov 29-Dec 5	Taper (Chapter 16 day-by-day)	Sleeping early; logistics locked Dec 1; fresh on Dec 6	Cramming the last 48 hours. Freshness is worth more than one more pass.

A word about the school-and-CLAT juggle: many of you have pre-boards and internals inside these ten weeks. The calendar above assumes about 3 hours on a class day. On a genuinely crushed week, protect three things in order — the daily reading practice, the weekly GK fact sheet, and any scheduled mock. Everything else can flex; those three cannot, because they compound.

CHAPTER 6

English Language — 22-26 Marks You Can Bank On

Roughly 20% of the paper, and the section where improvement is fastest because it is pure process: the questions are standard, the passages run about 450 words, and the answers are almost always restatements of something the passage says or implies.

What actually gets asked

Question type	Typical share	How it is asked
Main idea / central theme	3-5	Which of the following best captures the author's main argument?
Inference	4-6	Which of the following can most reasonably be inferred from the passage?
Vocabulary in context	3-4	As used in the passage, the word 'X' most nearly means:
Tone / attitude	1-3	The author's attitude towards the subject can best be described as:
Detail / specific fact	3-5	According to the passage, which of the following is true of...?
Title or purpose	1-2	Which of the following is the most appropriate title for the passage?

Notice what is absent: grammar-rule questions, sentence correction, fill-in-the-blanks. CLAT stopped testing English as grammar years ago. It now tests whether you understand a dense passage the way a law student must — precisely, on the author's terms, without importing your own opinions.

The reading protocol that fixes accuracy

- 1 Read the passage once, at your natural pace, pen in hand. Underline the sentence that states the author's main claim and mark where each paragraph turns. Target: 4 to 5 minutes for a 450-word passage.
- 2 Before looking at options, say the main idea to yourself in one sentence. If you cannot, you have read too passively — reread the first and last paragraphs, where exam writers place the thesis more often than not.
- 3 Answer easy detail questions straight from memory; only inference and main-idea questions demand a second, targeted look at one paragraph.
- 4 Eliminate before you select. Wrong CLAT options are wrong in three standard ways: too broad, too narrow, or true-but-irrelevant. Label each rejected option with one of the three.
- 5 Vocabulary questions: substitute each option into the original sentence and read it aloud in your head. Context beats dictionary knowledge every single time.

A worked example: elimination in action

Suppose a passage argues that while digitising court records has improved access to judgments, it has quietly created a new problem: judgments are now written for database search engines, with dense paragraphs built around keywords, and young lawyers increasingly read only the paragraphs their search returns. The author calls this 'fragmented reading' and worries it erodes the habit of reading a judgment as a whole argument.

Q. The author's primary concern is that:

- A. Technology should not be used in the judicial system
- B. Keyword-centred writing is changing how young lawyers read judgments
- C. Court records are difficult to digitise correctly
- D. Young lawyers today are less talented than previous generations

Work through it: A is too broad — the author praises digitisation's benefits in the first clause. C is true-but-irrelevant — difficulty of digitisation is never discussed. D is not the author's claim — the concern is habits, not talent. B restates the passage's actual argument at the right scope. Every wrong option dies by a label: too broad, true-but-irrelevant, distortion. When you practise this labelling on every question, accuracy climbs without you reading any faster.

How to train it in Phases 1 and 2

Daily: two to three passages under a timer, plus the editorial habit from Chapter 4. Weekly: one timed block of the full English section (22-26 questions in about 28 minutes). Track two numbers in your error log — accuracy and average seconds per question. English is the only section where you should let seconds-per-question fall before you push accuracy higher, because it frees time for Legal Reasoning, the heaviest section by marks.

The 90-second escape valve

If any single English question has consumed 90 seconds, mark your best guess on the OMR sheet, circle the question number on the question paper, and move on. Circled questions are revisited in the final minutes of the paper; questions you sink four minutes into are not revisited by anyone, because the paper is over.

CHAPTER 7

Current Affairs and General Knowledge — The Memory Game

The largest section of the paper: 28-32 questions, about 25% of your marks, from passages of up to 450 words each. The passages give you context — a paragraph about a judgment, a summit, a policy — but the questions demand recall of names, dates, articles and facts the passage does not spell out. This is the section that punishes vague preparation most brutally.

What to cover, in priority order

- Legal and constitutional news of the last 12-18 months: significant Supreme Court and High Court judgments, new legislation and amendments, committee reports, and attorney and judicial appointments. This is the overlap with Legal Reasoning and with your future degree — it is tested heavily.
- Polity fundamentals: the Constitution's structure, fundamental rights and duties, key articles, landmark amendments, elections, and the working of Parliament. Static, finite, and high-yield.
- National current affairs: government schemes with their launch years and ministries, budget numbers that made news, economic survey headlines, and major appointments.
- International affairs: summits and organisations India engaged with, important treaties, conflicts in the news, and India's positions on them.
- The rest, in modest doses: sports tournaments with winners, major awards, science and technology milestones, and notable obituaries and books.

The system that makes it stick

Current Affairs fails as a subject when it is consumed but never consolidated. The fix is a two-loop system. Loop one, daily (45 minutes): read one newspaper properly — front page to editorials — plus a monthly compilation for catch-up. Loop two, weekly (90 minutes on Sunday): convert the week into a one-page fact sheet in your own handwriting — names, numbers, one-line significance. From November, revise only from these sheets; the act of having compressed the news yourself is what makes it retrievable under exam pressure. Chapter 19 has the fact-sheet template.

Month of news	Priority	Why
Oct-Dec 2026	Highest	The freshest cycle; certain presence in the December 6 paper
Jul-Oct 2026	Highest	Peak current-affairs density for a December exam
Jan-Jun 2026	High	The year's big themes; also feeds static-polity questions
2024-25	Medium	Long-running matters: judgments, schemes, treaties still in the news
Older static GK	Medium	Polity, history and landmark events — finite; revise from one standard compilation

A static-GK core list worth one evening each

If your polity basics are shaky, these six clusters cover most static questions CLAT asks. One evening each, from any standard school-polity book, with your own one-page summary per cluster:

- Fundamental Rights and Duties: the articles, what each protects, and famous cases attached to them.
- The structure of government: President, Prime Minister and Cabinet, Parliament's two houses, and how a bill becomes law.
- The judiciary: Supreme Court and High Courts, appointments, jurisdiction, and review powers.
- Amendments and constitutional landmarks: the big ones and what each changed.
- Elections and the Election Commission: how India votes, delimitation, and the model code of conduct.
- Federalism: Union and State lists, Finance Commission, Article 356, and inter-state relations.

Two honest warnings. First, do not collect more sources in the last month — one paper, one monthly magazine, your own sheets, nothing else. Second, accept that you will not know everything; GK is where the top 5% tolerates uncertainty best. A blank you leave costs 1 mark; a confident wrong guess costs 1.25. Never spend three minutes of a 120-minute paper on a one-mark fact you do not know.

CHAPTER 8

Legal Reasoning — The Section That Decides Ties

Legal Reasoning carries 28-32 questions — about a quarter of the paper — and one more thing no other section does: the Consortium's official tie-breaker. When two candidates finish on identical marks, the one with the higher Legal Reasoning score wins the rank. In a field of 72,000, ties are not rare. This is your priority section.

The reassuring part: CLAT does not require you to have read any law. The official guidance frames the section around reasoning about fact situations, with principles often supplied in the passage, and general awareness of current legal and moral issues helping you engage with the scenarios. The skill is applying a stated rule to new facts — exactly what first-year law students spend months learning. You are being tested on the aptitude, not the knowledge.

The principle-application method

- 1 Read the passage and isolate the principle: the rule the author or the scenario treats as governing. It is usually stated plainly, and the questions revolve around it.

- 2 Restate the principle in your own words in one line. If you cannot restate it, you have not understood it, and every question in that passage is now a guess.
- 3 For each fact-based question, apply the rule mechanically. Do not import fairness, morality, or your opinion of what the law should be. The exam rewards fidelity to the given principle, not legal sophistication.
- 4 Watch for the classic trap: options that state a correct-sounding legal generalisation the given principle does not actually support. Correct answers are correct under this rule, in these facts, not in the abstract.
- 5 Current-affairs-adjacent passages (a recent judgment, a debate on a new law) pair your GK from Chapter 7 with this method — another reason legal news was at the top of that priority list.

Worked example 1: strict application

Principle as given in a passage: 'A shopkeeper who displays goods with a price tag makes an invitation to treat, not an offer. The contract is formed only when the shopkeeper accepts the customer's offer to buy at that price.'

Facts: R displays a shirt priced at Rs. 500. S, a customer, takes it to the counter and says 'I will buy this.' R says, 'The price is now Rs. 700.' Under the given principle, is there a contract at Rs. 500?

Walk it mechanically: display = invitation to treat; S's statement = the offer; R's response = not an acceptance but a counter-offer. No contract exists at Rs. 500 — indeed no contract exists yet at all. Notice how little law you needed: the passage handed you the entire rule. What was tested was the discipline of following it instead of your instinct that 'a price tag means the shopkeeper must sell at that price'. That instinct is the trap.

Worked example 2: principle meets new facts

Principle as given: 'A person who voluntarily undertakes to do an act, and does it negligently so that another suffers loss, is liable regardless of any contract between them.'

Facts: A neighbour promises to water your plants while you travel, does so carelessly, and the plants die. There was no payment, no contract — just a friendly promise. Liability?

The legal instinct might scream 'no contract, no liability'. But the principle does not mention contract — it needs (1) a voluntary undertaking, (2) negligence, (3) loss. All three exist, so under this rule, liability follows. Exam questions are full of gaps like this between real-world law and the stated principle; the marks go to whoever follows the stated rule.

Drill	Volume	What it builds
Principle-application sets (rule given, facts given, apply)	10-15 questions daily, Phase 1	The core move of the section
Passage-based legal sets (~450 words, 5-8 questions)	2 daily from Week 2	Reading + application under time
Legal news file (one judgment or bill per day, one-page note)	Daily, continuous	Context for scenario passages and GK overlap
Full timed section (28-32 questions in about 34 minutes)	Weekly from Phase 2	Pacing and stamina

A caution about law knowledge

Some aspirants spend months memorising law — contracts, torts, penal codes — for a test that stopped rewarding it. Deep legal knowledge is neither required nor directly rewarded, and the hours it eats belong to Current Affairs and mock analysis. Read law news as a citizen preparing for legal studies, not as a law student. The section tests how you think; give it thinking practice, not memorisation.

CHAPTER 9

Logical Reasoning — Where Discipline Pays Twice

About 20% of the paper, and the closest thing CLAT has to a pure-skill section: arguments in ~450-word passages, with questions on assumptions, inferences, argument strength, analogies and conclusions. Almost nobody 'knows' this section — it is trained, like a sport. That is good news for a 73-day sprinter, because trained gains arrive fast.

Question type	The task	The trap
Assumption	Identify what unstated premise the argument needs to stand	Options that are merely relevant, not necessary
Inference	What follows strictly from the stated facts	Options that follow plausibly but not necessarily
Strengthen / weaken	Which new fact moves the argument's force	Options that attack a different claim than the one made
Conclusion / main point	Summarise what the argument establishes	Options that pick one paragraph's point, not the whole passage's
Analogy / principle	Match the reasoning pattern to a parallel case	Surface similarity with different logical structure
Course of action / reasoning errors	Spot flawed reasoning or the best next step	Options that fix the symptom, not the logic

The three habits that build the section

- Premise-conclusion tagging. For every passage, physically mark P1, P2... and C. Most Logical Reasoning errors are really reading errors — answering the question you assumed, not the argument the author made. Tagging forces the discipline.
- The 'must be so' test for inference. An inference must be true if the passage is true — not likely, not probably. Ask of each option: must this be so, given what is stated? It sounds pedantic; it is worth 8 to 10 marks.
- Prediction before options. For strengthen/weaken, say what kind of fact would move the argument before reading options. You will be wrong sometimes, but you stop being seduced by the first plausible-sounding option.

Worked example: the assumption, found

Argument: 'The city council should replace the streetlights on MG Road with LED units. In cities that have done this, electricity bills fell by 40%, and the new units need replacement only once a decade.'

Q. Which of the following is an assumption required by the argument?

- A. LED streetlights provide better illumination than the units they replace
- B. The savings on electricity and maintenance exceed the cost of the replacement
- C. Other cities are similar to ours
- D. The council has money in this year's budget

Test the argument's engine: it wants money savings to justify the switch. For that arithmetic to work, the savings must exceed the upfront cost — if they did not, the recommendation collapses. That is B. A (illumination) is about something the argument never claims; C is a comparison the argument does not rest on ('cities that have done this' is evidence of savings, not of similarity); D is a practical question that could defeat implementation but not the argument's own logic. The right assumption is the one the argument cannot survive without — a necessary load-bearing wall, not a nice decoration.

How to train it

Phase 1: 15-20 questions daily, untimed, with a written one-line reason for every error — not 'silly mistake' but which trap (see the table above) you fell for. Phase 2: 10-15 questions daily timed at about 60 seconds each, because this section's questions are individually shorter than English or Legal ones and should bank time for elsewhere. Track seconds-per-question weekly; Logical Reasoning is your time donor for the paper.

CHAPTER 10

Quantitative Techniques — Small Section, Big Traps

The smallest section — 10-14 questions, about 10% of the paper — and the one most aspirants get badly wrong twice. The first error is over-investing: re-learning Class 11 and 12 mathematics. The official scope is Class 10 level, tested through short sets of facts or propositions, graphs, tables and other data, followed by clusters of questions on them. The second error is under-investing: skipping the section out of fear, and leaving 10-14 easy marks on the table.

Topic cluster	Questions to expect	What to revise
Ratios, percentages, averages	2-4	Percentage change, successive change, weighted averages, mixtures
Data interpretation: tables and charts	3-5	Reading speed from tables, bar and line graphs, pie shares
Rate, time, work and speed-distance	1-3	Basic work-rate and relative-speed setups
Basic algebra and simple equations	1-2	Linear equations from word problems
Numbers, basic geometry, mensuration	0-2	Squares and fraction-decimal conversions, area and volume basics

Worked example: a data cluster, done the fast way

A typical set gives a small table — say, four years of a state's legal-aid budget in crore rupees: 2022: 40; 2023: 50; 2024: 52; 2025: 65 — followed by three questions. Spend the first 45 seconds just reading the table: units (crore), direction (rising), the one anomaly (a small 2024 jump), and roughly how fast the series grows. Then the questions become 30-second affairs:

- 'By what percentage did the budget grow from 2022 to 2025?' — growth of 25 on a base of 40 = 62.5%. One clean fraction, no formulas beyond percentage change.

- 'In which year was the percentage growth over the previous year the highest?' — the 2023 jump is $10/40 = 25\%$; 2024 is $2/50 = 4\%$; 2025 is $13/52 = 25\%$. A near tie between 2023 and 2025 — check by exact value, and the estimate you pre-computed carries you there in seconds.
- 'If the 2026 budget grows at the same rate as 2025's, what will it be?' — $13/52$ means a quarter again: about 81 crore. Approximation lands within any realistic option spacing.

That is the whole section in miniature: modest arithmetic, done confidently on a well-understood table. Every hour spent on advanced mathematics beyond this is an hour taken from Legal Reasoning, which is worth twice as many marks.

The strategy for a 10% section

- Target 60-70% of the section — roughly 7 to 9 of the 10-14 questions — at very high accuracy, not 100% at shaky accuracy. DI clusters reward choosing your battles.
- Solve from the set, not the section: every question in a cluster shares one data table. Digest the table once, and individual questions drop to 30-45 seconds each.
- Approximate deliberately. Options are usually spaced far enough that rounding to the nearest clean number finishes the job.
- Daily dose: one 25-minute set in Phase 1, one every other day in Phase 2, nothing but warm-up sets in Phase 3. Quant decays slower than you fear; GK decays faster than you think.

The math-fear exit

If your diagnostic shows Quant accuracy below 40%, do not try to save the section — protect the other 108 marks first. One strong pass through percentages, ratios and table-reading covers most of what the section actually tests. Leave the rest; 0 for an unanswered question is the cheapest outcome in CLAT.

CHAPTER 11

The Reading-Speed Program

Every section of CLAT is a reading test wearing a costume. Before you dismiss speed work as a nice-to-have, measure yourself: most school students read serious prose at 150 to 200 words per minute. The paper rewards 250 to 300 wpm with comprehension intact. That gap, closed over ten weeks, is worth more than any single topic you could study.

Week 1-2: the baseline and the habit

- Measure your baseline: take a 450-word editorial, time yourself, count the words covered, divide. Write the number down — this is your 150-to-200 reality check.
- Read two editorials daily with the three-line summary habit (Chapter 4). Do not chase speed yet; chase complete understanding.
- Read with a pen or your finger guiding your eyes down the line. It feels childish for two days and then quietly adds 20-30 wpm by stopping back-skipping — the unconscious re-reading of phrases that slows everyone down.

Weeks 3-6: deliberate pushes

- Three sessions a week, do the same editorial drill at 110% of comfortable speed — slightly rushed, comprehension allowed to dip. The next session, comprehension returns at the new speed. This is how speed is actually built: push, settle, push.

- Once a week, read a passage and write its structure in the margin as you go: claim, reason, turn, conclusion. Structure-spotting is what lets fast readers keep comprehension at speed.
- Stop sub-vocalising celebrity names and numbers — your eyes can take them in faster than your inner voice can say them. Speed readers are not skipping; they are grouping words into phrases, roughly three per eye-stop.

Weeks 7-10: exam-format consolidation

- All reading practice now happens in exam format: ~450-word passages with questions, timed. Your target: passage read and questions answered in 4 to 5 minutes for English, slightly longer for Legal where application questions follow.
- Re-measure every Sunday. A healthy curve: baseline +30 wpm by week 4, +50 by week 8, plateau near 280 wpm — beyond which accuracy, not speed, is your binding constraint.
- Guard the other side: if accuracy drops while speed rises, you have crossed your personal redline. Back off 10%; that point IS your optimal exam pace. Speed beyond your comprehension line is just faster guessing.

One caution: this program cannot be compressed into the last month. Reading speed is a physiological habit, like running cadence — it adapts over weeks of consistent stimulus, not days of heroic effort. If you are starting this book with less than six weeks left, do the baseline and the habit phase only, and pour everything else into accuracy.

CHAPTER 12

The Mock System: The 3:1 Rule

Most aspirants take mocks and get nothing from them. They finish, check answers, feel something (good or bad), and repeat. Ten mocks taken that way improve nothing except familiarity with the format. This chapter is the system that makes mocks pay — and it fits in one sentence: for every hour of testing, invest three hours of analysis.

A CLAT mock is 2 hours, so the full cycle is 8 hours: 2 attempting, 6 analysing, spread across the two days after the mock. That sounds heavy. It is. It is also the entire difference between the aspirant whose tenth mock score equals their second, and the one whose score curve bends upward.

The analysis, step by step

- 1 Section scoreboard (30 minutes). Attempts, correct, wrong, accuracy, and time spent per section. Copy it into one running sheet per mock (the log in Chapter 19). You are looking for trends, not feelings: is accuracy falling in a section as attempts rise? Is time leaking into one question type?
- 2 Question-level autopsy (2.5 hours). Re-solve every question you got wrong — cold, without looking at the answer. Then classify it: (a) concept gap, (b) misread, (c) trap, (d) time pressure, (e) careless OMR or calculation slip. The category tells you the fix: concept gaps get drills, misreads get the reading protocol from Chapter 6, traps get noted in your trap journal, time pressure gets the 90-second valve, careless slips get the checklist in Chapter 17.
- 3 The unattempted audit (1 hour). Would you have solved it with unlimited time? Then the problem is selection or fear, not knowledge — and the fix is your section timing plan, not more study. Would you not? File it under concept gap and move on.
- 4 The right-but-slow audit (1 hour). Every question you solved correctly in over 100 seconds: find the shortcut. A right answer at 150 seconds is a wrong answer in disguise on a 120-minute clock.

- 5 Plan adjustment (30 minutes). Write three sentences: what I will change next mock, what I will drill this week, what I will ignore because it was noise. Then actually change it next mock.

Error type	Fix	Where
Concept gap	Targeted drill set within 48 hours	Chapters 6-10 playbooks
Misread question or passage	Reading protocol: restate before answering	Chapters 6, 9
Trap option chosen	Trap journal; label rejections as too-broad / too-narrow / irrelevant	Chapter 6
Time pressure	90-second valve; fixed section order and clocks	Chapter 13
Careless or OMR slip	Pre-submit checklist: final 5 minutes, batch-check OMR rows	Chapter 17

One rule about mock scores: they are data, not verdicts. A mock exists to expose weakness while it is still free to fix. The aspirant who scores 68 and feels defeated studies worse that week; the one who scores 68 and finds two fixable leaks gains 6 marks by Sunday. Treat every mock between now and November 21 as an instrument reading — the exam is on December 6, and only that day's reading counts.

CHAPTER 13

Scoring Math and Attempt Strategy

One table in this chapter is worth more than a week of hard study. It is the arithmetic of CLAT's marking — +1 per correct, -0.25 per wrong — applied to realistic attempt-and-accuracy profiles. Find your current profile, then see what the same effort earns at higher accuracy.

Profile	Attempts	Accuracy	Correct	Wrong	Score
Panicked plower	120	60%	72	48	60.00
Blunt aggression	110	70%	77	33	68.75
Balanced (first target)	105	75%	79	26	72.50
Disciplined (second target)	100	82%	82	18	77.50
Selection master (aim here)	95	88%	84	11	81.25
Elite	100	90%	90	10	87.50

The lesson of the table: from 'blunt aggression' to 'selection master', attempts fall by 15 and the score rises by almost 13 marks. In a field of 72,000, 13 marks is a very large distance in ranks. Your Phase 2 mission is not to attempt more questions — it is to attempt better ones.

The guessing math, honestly stated

With four options, a purely blind guess has an expected value of +0.0625 — one-sixteenth of a mark. Positive, but trivial. The moment you can eliminate even one option, the expectation roughly triples; eliminate two and it reaches +0.375. So the rule is: guess freely when you have killed at least one option; guess neutrally if you must fill the OMR anyway; but never spend scarce minutes converting a guess into a considered guess. Minutes are the real currency of this paper, and the right-but-slow audit is where you reclaim them.

A section clock that works

No section timers exist, so you must impose your own. The order below is a proven default; adjust by one position at most after Mock 5, then freeze it:

Order	Section	Time budget	Rationale
1	Quantitative Techniques	20 min	Smallest, most decisive; do it fresh, never rushed at the end
2	Logical Reasoning	25 min	Short questions, banks time; momentum while fresh
3	English Language	28 min	Steady reading work mid-paper
4	Legal Reasoning	34 min	Heaviest by marks and tie-breaker; needs full focus
5	Current Affairs + GK	15 min	You know it or you don't; fast picks, no agonising
-	Buffer and review	8 min	Flagged questions, OMR check, guessing pass

GK last is deliberate: it is the section least harmed by fatigue and time pressure. Quant first is deliberate too: for most aspirants it is the section most damaged by being rushed at the end of a two-hour paper. Whatever your order, write it on your rough sheet the moment the paper begins and defend it — mid-exam improvisation is how 20-minute sections become 35-minute sections.

Which questions to skip first

Deciding what not to attempt is a skill with its own logic. In order, the first sacrifices on a CLAT paper are:

- 1 GK questions where no option even looks familiar — zero information means the guess is blind and the time is pure loss.
- 2 Quant questions requiring a technique you have not used in a month — recognition without fluency is a trap under time pressure.
- 3 Legal Reasoning questions where two options both seem to satisfy the principle — these are usually testing a distinction you are not seeing, and three minutes will not find it.
- 4 English vocabulary questions where you know three of the four options are wrong but cannot decide on the fourth — this is exactly the 50-50 that the buffer time exists for, not the middle of the paper.
- 5 Never sacrifice: detail questions in passages you have already read, GK questions where one option is familiar, and any question you can solve in under 45 seconds. These are the marks your rank is built from.

CHAPTER 14

Registration Traps and Deadlines

Every year, capable aspirants lose their CLAT candidature to paperwork — not to the paper. The Consortium's official instructions spell out the rules; this chapter turns them into a checklist. Registration is open now and closes October 31, 2026, 11:59 PM. Do not wait for the last week; portal congestion and payment failures are a real October 30-31 tradition.

- 1 Register with your own mobile number and email — an OTP validates the number, and all counselling communication lands on these. Shared family numbers create lost-access nightmares in December.

- 2 Spell your name and your parents' names exactly as they appear on your Class 10 / 12 certificates and ID proof. The Consortium's instructions are explicit: alterations found later can disqualify the candidature.
- 3 Choose programme (UG or PG), category and BPL status carefully: once the application is submitted and paid, these three cannot be changed.
- 4 Fill your Class 12 details accurately. If you are appearing in March/April 2027 boards, you are eligible — you will produce passing evidence at admission.
- 5 Pick your three exam-centre preferences in order of travel convenience — and if you had chosen Vellore or Tiruvarur (removed for CLAT 2027), edit your preferences before October 31.
- 6 Upload only PDFs, per the official instructions: a recent front-facing passport photo on a plain background, your signature, and category / PwD / BPL certificates from the competent authority where applicable. The photo and signature do not need attestation.
- 7 Pay online (Rs. 4,000 General/OBC; Rs. 3,500 SC/ST/BPL/PwD) and keep the transaction record. Fees are non-refundable and non-adjustable, and bank charges are extra.
- 8 Take a final full review of the form before submitting. Only the last submitted application counts if you file more than one, and earlier fees are not refunded.
- 9 Download and print the admit card when it is released (the date will be intimated on the website). Check the centre address against your route the same day.

The three cancellation triggers, in the Consortium's own rules

1) False or incorrect information at any stage — provisional admission stands cancelled without further reason. 2) A mismatch between the category claimed and the certificate produced at admission — you are then considered outside that reservation category in subsequent rounds. 3) Failure to produce evidence of passing the qualifying examination at admission — the right to be considered is lost. All three are administrative. All three are avoidable in twenty careful minutes.

CHAPTER 15

After the Exam: Results and Counselling

The Consortium's official FAQ places CLAT 2027 counselling in December 2026 / January 2027. The exact calendar publishes after the exam, but the process itself is stable year to year — and knowing it now changes one thing you do before the exam: how seriously you fill your NLU preference list. Here is the shape of the process, using the CLAT 2026 cycle as the illustration.

Stage (CLAT 2026 illustration)	What happened
Result	Declared within roughly ten days of the exam
Counselling registration	Opened about ten days after the exam; ran about ten days (Dec 17-27, 2025)
Counselling registration fee	Rs. 30,000 (General); Rs. 20,000 (SC/ST/OBC/BC/EWS/PwD), paid online
Preference filling	Minimum 15 university choices for UG
Allotment rounds	Five rounds, first list about a month after the exam, later rounds through May

Stage (CLAT 2026 illustration)	What happened
Options each round	Freeze (accept seat), Float (hold seat, stay in line for higher preference), Exit (leave; confirmation fee forfeited)
Seat confirmation	Confirmation fee for Freeze/Float choices; balance university fees after adjustment
Withdrawal cost	Exit after freezing: counselling fee refunded minus Rs. 5,000

Three decisions in this process deserve thought before results day, not during it.

- The preference list is not a wish list. It is the queue you will be served from. Order the NLUs by where you would actually attend, factoring in fee structures (which differ sharply between NLUs and are published in the Consortium's brochure), domicile quotas where they apply to you, and the programmes themselves. Fill all 15 choices — an empty slot can only hurt you.
- Money matters at every stage. The counselling registration fee is significant (Rs. 30,000 general in the 2026 cycle) and is adjusted against university fees if you take a seat, largely refunded if you never accept one, and partially forfeited if you exit after freezing. Know which situation you are in before you click.
- Float is usually correct when you hold a lower preference. You keep the seat while remaining eligible for a higher one. But a frozen seat you never take to university costs real money — check the refund rules in the year's official counselling instructions before deciding.

The official counselling instructions for the year — published on the Consortium website — are the binding document; treat this chapter as the map and that document as the territory. Read it the day it releases, with your family and your budget in the room.

CHAPTER 16

The Last Week: A Day-By-Day Taper

The taper's job is retrieval, rhythm and rest — in that order. Everything below is light by design. If you find yourself wanting to cram furiously in the last three days, that is not diligence; it is anxiety wearing a study costume. Follow the plan anyway.

Day	Plan	Purpose
Mon, Nov 30	GK sheets full revision pass 1 (3 hrs); one Quant warm-up set; sleep at normal hour	Retrieval of the biggest section
Tue, Dec 1	Light mock 1 (2 PM-4 PM) + 1-hour review only; print admit card (2 copies), verify centre address and route	Rhythm + logistics locked early
Wed, Dec 2	Legal Reasoning error log re-solve; GK pass 2 on weakest 30% of sheets; 30-min editorial reading	Tie-breaker section stays sharp
Thu, Dec 3	English + Logical error log re-solve; GK mixed self-quiz; pack the exam kit (see Chapter 17)	Confidence from re-solving what once beat you
Fri, Dec 4	Light mock 2 (2 PM-4 PM), no analysis beyond 30 minutes; November current affairs one final pass	Last exposure to exam-slot alertness
Sat, Dec 5	Skim GK sheets (90 min max); walk or exercise; travel to exam city if outstation; early dinner, early sleep	Freshness beats one more revision pass
Sun, Dec 6	Wake at 8; light breakfast; leave early for a 2:00 PM start; no new material, no group chats	The work is done — execute it

What 'done' feels like

By the evening of December 5 you should feel slightly under-stimulated — that is what a proper taper does. Trust it. You have spent ten weeks loading the material; the taper is the silence before it plays. The candidates around you who are still frantically flipping through GK compilations at 11 PM on Saturday are not adding marks; they are spending sleep they will need at 3 PM on Sunday.

CHAPTER 17

Exam-Day Protocol for a 2 PM Start

A 2:00 PM start is unusual for Indian entrance exams, and it rewires the whole day. The biggest risk is not the paper — it is a heavy lunch, a sleepy afternoon brain, and a rushed entry. Here is the protocol, reverse-engineered from the clock.

Time	Action
8:00 AM	Wake; shower; 20 minutes of light GK skimming only (your own sheets)
9:30 AM	A proper breakfast — the meal that powers 2:00 PM
10:30 AM	One 25-minute warm-up: 10 easy Logical or English questions, just to switch the brain on
11:30 AM	Lunch: moderate, low-oil, familiar food; nothing experimental
12:15 PM	Check the exam kit (see below); hand your phone to a family member if possible
12:30 PM	Leave for the centre, targeting arrival 90 minutes early; account for traffic and gate queues
1:00 PM	Arrive; locate your hall and washroom; drink water; stay out of anxious huddles and last-minute GK gossip
1:30 PM	Entry, seating, ID and admit-card checks, form-filling
2:00-4:00 PM	The paper: run your section clock, the 90-second valve, and the 5-minute OMR check
4:00 PM	Exit; do not post-mortem with the crowd; the paper is done

The exam kit

Two printed admit-card copies, one government photo ID (the one your application details match), two blue/black ballpoint pens you have already written with, a water bottle if the centre permits, a light snack for after, and nothing else — no watches, phones, notes or smart devices, which centres prohibit. Wear comfortable clothes you have sat in for three hours before.

Inside the paper: the five-point discipline

- 1 Write your section order on the rough sheet in the first minute and follow it.
- 2 Mark the OMR in batches as you finish each passage's questions — never save 40 bubbles for the end; a single misalignment there costs more than any question.
- 3 Run the 90-second valve honestly. Circled questions on the question paper get revisited in the buffer time.
- 4 Reserve the final 5 minutes strictly for the OMR: check every filled row against the question number once, fill any blanks you owe a guess to, and stop.
- 5 If a section goes badly, let it go mid-paper. One bad section costs 20 marks; panic spreading to the next two costs 40.

One last mental note, and it matters: the exam starts at 2:00 PM, and most of your rivals have spent their entire preparation testing themselves in mornings. Your 2:00 PM mock habit from Phase 2 is a genuine competitive edge. Walk in knowing your brain has been to this exact room, at this exact hour, twenty times before.

CHAPTER 18

Questions Aspirants Actually Ask

Is 73 days enough to crack CLAT 2027?

Yes, with two conditions: you already read English comfortably at school level, and you follow a structured plan instead of grazing. CLAT tests reading and reasoning more than accumulated knowledge, and both respond fast to deliberate practice. This book's three-phase plan is built exactly for this runway.

I have board exams in March 2027. Does preparing for CLAT now hurt my boards?

No — the overlap runs the other way. The eligibility rule requires 45% in Class 12 (40% for SC/ST/PwD), so boards cannot be sacrificed, but CLAT's English, Logical and Quant work sharpens the very skills your board English and Maths papers reward. After December 6 you have four clear months of board-only focus.

How many mocks should I take?

Ten full mocks between October 19 and November 21, plus two light ones in the final week. More is pointless without the 3:1 analysis; fewer starves you of data. One every third or fourth day, always at 2:00 PM.

Which newspaper should I read?

One, daily, cover to cover for editorials and news — The Hindu or Indian Express are the usual choices. Pair it with one monthly compilation for revision. Two papers is consumption; one paper plus your own weekly fact sheets is preparation.

Do I need to study actual law for Legal Reasoning?

No. The section tests application of stated principles and reasoning about fact situations, not memorised statutes. Follow Chapter 8's method and keep a light file of current legal news.

Is it better to leave a question blank or guess?

Blank costs 0; a wrong guess costs 0.25 net. A fully blind guess averages +0.0625, so it barely matters either way. Eliminate at least one option and guessing becomes clearly worth it. What is never worth it is spending real minutes on a coin flip.

What if I miss the October 31 registration deadline?

There is no extension promised and no late window. The application closes 11:59 PM on October 31, 2026, and the fee is non-refundable — so apply this week, not in the last week's crowd.

Can I change my exam centre after submitting?

The application allows edits until closure; after the October 31 deadline, updates are not entertained. If you had picked Vellore or Tiruvarur, you must edit before that date. Your final allotted centre appears on the admit card.

What score gets me a top NLU?

Nobody honestly knows for CLAT 2027 — cutoffs move with difficulty, applicant growth (17% last year) and seats. What you control is the Chapter 13 table: attempts times accuracy. Push that product up every mock and the rank takes care of itself.

How do I handle a bad mock streak in Phase 2?

Check your analysis quality first — a bad streak with weak analysis usually means the mocks are measuring mood, not learning. If analysis is honest and scores still stall, take two days off from testing (drills only). The streak almost always breaks on return.

Should I join a coaching class with 73 days left?

Probably not a full classroom program — there is no time for it to complete a syllabus you mostly do not need. What is worth buying at this stage: a reputed mock series (you need ten papers), the Consortium's official past papers (Rs. 500), and optionally a monthly GK compilation. This playbook does the structuring a coaching class would.

What do I do between the exam and results?

Rest for three days — genuinely. Then, if boards loom in March 2027, switch your full attention there; the ~10-day result wait (see Chapter 15) needs nothing from you. When the counselling instructions release, read them with your family and prepare your preference list and budget before the registration window opens.

CHAPTER 19**Worksheets You Can Print and Use**

Four tools from the chapters, laid out as templates. Print them or copy the structure into a notebook — the mock log is used after every mock (ten times), the GK fact sheet every Sunday (ten times), the preference worksheet in December, and the exam kit checklist the night before December 6.

Worksheet 1: The mock log (one row per mock)

Field	Entry
Mock number and date	e.g., Mock 4 — Nov 1
Total score / 120	
Attempts / accuracy	
English: attempts, correct, time	
GK: attempts, correct, time	
Legal: attempts, correct, time	
Logical: attempts, correct, time	
Quant: attempts, correct, time	
Top error category (Ch. 12 autopsy)	
One thing to change next mock	
One thing to drill this week	

Worksheet 2: The weekly GK fact sheet

One page per week, your handwriting, your words. Each line: what happened, one name or number it will be tested by, one line of significance.

Area	This week's entries
Legal / constitutional news	
National policy and economy	
International affairs	
Appointments and awards	
Sports, science, miscellany	
Editorial themes worth re-reading	

Worksheet 3: The NLU preference draft (before counselling)

Fifteen rows. For each NLU, fill: annual fee (from the Consortium brochure), whether a domicile quota helps you, and a one-line reason it sits at this rank. The point of the draft is that your December list is a decision you made calmly in advance — not one you make in a 60-minute window on results week.

#	University	Annual fee	Domicile edge?	Why this rank
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

(Continue rows 6 to 15 on your own paper — the full worksheet is one list of fifteen.)

Worksheet 4: The exam kit and morning checklist (Dec 5 night)

- Two printed admit-card copies, kept in different bags or pockets
- Government photo ID, matching the name on the application
- Two blue/black ballpoint pens, tested on paper
- Water bottle (if the centre permits) and a light post-exam snack
- Centre address screenshotted offline; route and travel time decided on Dec 1
- Alarm set for 8:00 AM; breakfast planned; lunch planned (light, familiar)
- No phone in your pocket during the paper — hand it over before leaving home

CHAPTER 20

Five Practice Passages, Fully Solved

One passage for each section, in the exam's own style, with the answer key and explanations at the end. Use these three ways: as a fresh drill today, as a teaching example when a section misbehaves in a mock, and as a demonstration of the protocols from Chapters 6 to 10 in action. Time yourself honestly: about 5 minutes per passage.

Passage 1 — English Language

The Right to Information Act was born of the suspicion that a citizen's business with the state was none of the citizen's business. Files moved; the citizen waited. What the Act changed was not merely the availability of documents but the direction of the question: for the first time, the state had to explain to the citizen why a file slept. Yet two decades on, the tool that was meant to discipline bureaucracy has itself been bureaucratised. Requests vanish into transfer loops between departments; appeals queue behind vacancies in information commissions; and the busiest users of the Act today are often not citizens seeking their own entitlements but companies mining competitors' licences. None of this argues that the law failed. It argues that transparency is not an event that a statute completes but a practice a society maintains — and that the maintenance has, of late, been deferred.

1. The author's main argument is that:

- A. The Right to Information Act has completely failed to help citizens
- B. Transparency requires ongoing upkeep, not merely the passing of a law
- C. Companies should be banned from filing RTI requests
- D. Information commissions are deliberately understaffed

2. The phrase 'why a file slept' is used to convey:

- A. That government offices close early
- B. That official work was left pending without explanation
- C. That documents are stored in poor conditions
- D. That the state was indifferent to judicial deadlines

3. The author's tone can best be described as:

- A. Indignant
- B. Detached
- C. Critical but measured
- D. Ironical

4. Which of the following can most reasonably be inferred from the passage?

- A. Before the Act, citizens had no legal right to any government document
- B. The Act's heaviest users have changed over time
- C. Appeals to information commissions are always rejected
- D. The Act made all government files public by default

Passage 2 — Current Affairs and General Knowledge

Every January, the nation pauses for its Republic Day parade, and every few years the ceremony acquires a new diplomatic signature. In recent editions, the chief guest at the parade has become a statement of foreign policy: a French President, leaders of ASEAN states, an Egyptian head of state, and most recently a leader from the Gulf — each visit marking a corridor of partnership New Delhi is investing in. The Constitution whose adoption the parade celebrates came into force in 1950, replacing the Government of India Act as the country's fundamental governing document, and its length is itself a subject of GK questions.

5. The Constitution of India came into force on:

- A. August 15, 1947
- B. January 26, 1950
- C. November 26, 1949
- D. October 2, 1950

6. November 26 is observed in India as:

- A. Republic Day
- B. Constitution Day
- C. Law Day only, for the legal profession
- D. Unity Day

7. The passage suggests that the choice of chief guest at the parade is:

- A. A purely ceremonial matter
- B. A signal of India's strategic partnerships
- C. Decided by the armed forces
- D. Rotated alphabetically by country

Passage 3 — Legal Reasoning

Principle, as given: 'A person who keeps a dangerous animal is strictly liable — liable without proof of any negligence — for harm the animal causes, regardless of how carefully the animal was kept. For all other animals, liability arises only if the keeper knew of the animal's dangerous tendency and failed to take reasonable care.'

Facts: K keeps a pet monkey that has never bitten anyone in eight years. One evening, without warning, the monkey scratches a visitor, V, who needed medical treatment. V sues K.

8. Under the given principle, is K liable?

- A. Yes, because keeping any animal that harms a visitor triggers strict liability
- B. Yes, but only if the monkey is classified as a dangerous animal under wildlife law
- C. No, because strict liability applies only to dangerous animals, and no knowledge of dangerous tendency was shown
- D. No, because a visitor assumes all risks on entering another's home

9. Which fact, if true, would change the answer under the given principle?

- A. V had been invited for a business meeting rather than a social visit
- B. The monkey had bitten a delivery worker a month earlier, and K knew of it
- C. V's treatment cost a very large sum
- D. K's home is in a state where monkeys are worshipped

10. The structure of the given principle most resembles:

- A. A two-tier rule: one standard for inherently dangerous things, another for the rest
- B. A single standard of care applying uniformly to all keepers
- C. A rule that makes all animal-keepers insurers of their guests
- D. A procedural rule about who may file suit

Passage 4 — Logical Reasoning

A state's legal-services authority argues that duty counsel should be stationed inside police stations during evening hours. Its evidence: in the districts where lawyers were present during interrogation, the number of complaints of coerced confessions fell to nearly zero, and confession-based convictions did not fall at all. Opponents reply that the presence of lawyers simply discourages suspects from confessing at all, which will lengthen investigations.

11. The opponents' reply is weakened most by which of the following, if true?

- A. Lawyers are also available to suspects after they are produced before a magistrate
- B. Confession-based convictions did not fall in the districts with duty counsel
- C. Evening hours are when most interrogations occur
- D. Some suspects confess voluntarily even with counsel present

12. The authority's evidence supports its recommendation only if which of the following is assumed?

- A. Coerced confessions are a harm worth preventing even at some cost to investigation speed
- B. Duty counsel work is not expensive
- C. Police officers welcome the presence of lawyers
- D. Complaints of coercion were accurately reported before the programme

Passage 5 — Quantitative Techniques

A state legal-aid department's yearly expenditure, in crore rupees, on legal aid clinics and on awareness campaigns, over four years:

Year	Clinics (Rs. cr)	Awareness (Rs. cr)
2022	40	10
2023	50	12
2024	52	18
2025	65	20

13. Total legal-aid spending in 2025 exceeded that in 2022 by:

- A. 55%
- B. 62.5%
- C. 70%
- D. 75%

14. In which year did awareness spending form the highest share of the total?

- A. 2022
- B. 2023
- C. 2024
- D. 2025

15. The approximate average yearly growth rate of clinic spending across the three intervals is closest to:

- A. 15%
- B. 17%
- C. 20%
- D. 25%

Answer key and explanations

Q	Ans	Why
1	B	A is too broad (the author explicitly says 'this does not argue that the law failed'); C and D are not proposed. B captures the closing claim: transparency is a practice, not an event.
2	B	Context: files 'moved' while 'the citizen waited' — sleeping = pending unexplained. C and A read the metaphor literally; D imports an outside idea.
3	C	The author criticises deferral but concedes the law's achievements — measured, not indignant or detached.
4	B	Stated directly: 'the busiest users today are often... companies'. A, C and D all go beyond or against the text.
5	B	Adopted November 26, 1949; in force January 26, 1950 — which is why January 26 is Republic Day.
6	B	Constitution Day (Samvidhan Divas) marks adoption, November 26, 1949.
7	B	The passage's whole first half: the guest 'has become a statement of foreign policy'.
8	C	Strict liability attaches only to dangerous animals; a monkey with no history of violence is not shown dangerous, and no knowledge-based liability arises without a known tendency.
9	B	A known prior bite supplies the 'knew of the animal's dangerous tendency' element, triggering the second limb. A, C and D add nothing to the principle's elements.
10	A	The principle runs on two standards: strict for dangerous things, negligence-plus-knowledge for others.
11	B	If convictions did not fall, confessions continued to occur — removing the claim that lawyers stop confessions. A, C and D leave the objection standing.
12	A	The recommendation trades some investigation friction for preventing coercion; unless preventing coercion is worth that cost, the evidence does not justify the policy. B and C are practicalities, not logical requirements.
13	C	2025 total 85 vs 2022 total 50; increase 35 on a base of 50 = 70%. The trap: option B (62.5%) is the clinic-only growth (65 over 40) — always check which total the question asks for.
14	C	Shares: 10/50 = 20%; 12/62 = 19.4%; 18/70 = 25.7%; 20/85 = 23.5% — highest in 2024.
15	B	Growth: 40 to 65 over three years; compound rate r satisfies $40(1+r)^3 = 65$, so $(1+r)^3 = 1.625$, $r =$ about 17.6% — nearest 17%.

Score yourself honestly: 1 mark per correct answer, minus 0.25 per wrong one, exactly as the real paper. Below 10 of 15, reread the relevant playbook chapter before drilling further questions; above 12, your protocols are working — now repeat the performance under a strict 22-minute clock to add the time dimension the exam will add for you.

CHAPTER 21

The Digital Discipline

CLAT preparation has a silent enemy that did not exist for any generation before yours: the phone on your desk. Ten weeks of attention is the entire raw material of this playbook, and every app on your home screen is engineered to tax it. This chapter is short because the fix is simple, not because the problem is small.

- Study in 45-minute blocks with the phone in another room — not face-down, not on silent: in another room. The mere presence of a visible phone measurably taxes attention; this is among the most replicated findings in the psychology of distraction.

- Leave every CLAT Telegram and WhatsApp group that has more anxiety than information. The three that help: one mocks group, your study partner, and nothing else. GK forwarded in groups is 10% fact and 90% noise; your own fact sheets are the antidote.
- Turn mock analysis into a paper activity. Screen-based review invites tab-drift; print your OMR and the answer key, use a red pen. The physical act also mirrors the pen-and-paper exam you will actually face.
- News on paper, not reels. If your household gets no newspaper, use the paper's own website — a deliberate 30-minute read, not an infinite scroll. GK retention from reading beats retention from video by a wide margin, because reading is the format you will retrieve it in.
- One screen holiday a week — half a day. The brain consolidates during rest, and a Sunday evening genuinely off does more for Monday's mock than Sunday evening revision.

A note for the repeat aspirant

If this is your second or third attempt, your biggest risk is not knowledge — it is stale patterns. You already own most of the syllabus; what you may be re-earning is the self-image of someone who has 'already prepared'. Treat every previous attempt as data in your error log: which section actually cost you last December, and was it skill, selection, or nerves? Build this cycle's plan around that answer rather than around redoing everything. And keep your mock scores to yourself; a repeat attempt needs privacy like a wound needs a bandage.

A note for the parent reading over a shoulder

What helps in these ten weeks is boring: regular meals, a quiet desk, an early wake-up enforced gently, and no interrogation after every mock. What hurts is also boring: comparison with other children, negotiation over phone time during study blocks, and late-November panic that becomes the household's weather. The exam is on a Sunday afternoon; the household's job is to make sure a rested, fed, unpanicked person walks into it. This playbook asks aspirants for about three focused hours a day — that is the whole ask. Everything beyond it should be rest, school, and being seventeen.

SOURCES AND VERIFICATION

Where every exam fact in this book comes from

Exam facts (dates, pattern, fees, eligibility, tie-breaks, counselling structure) were verified in September 2026 against the official Consortium of National Law Universities website:

- consortiumofnlus.ac.in — CLAT 2027 press release (July 22, 2026): exam date December 6, 2026; application window August 3 to October 31, 2026.
- clat2027.consortiumofnlus.ac.in — official UG question paper format (marks, duration, marking scheme, section weightages) and UG eligibility page; official FAQ (counselling timing).
- consortiumofnlus.ac.in/clat-2027/ug-instructions.html — application process, documents, fees, tie-break procedure, PwD timing, general instructions.
- consortiumofnlus.ac.in CLAT 2026 press release (December 2025) — applicant numbers, turnout, PwD candidates, centres and cities.
- Official CLAT 2026 admissions counselling instructions (Consortium of NLUs) — counselling fee, rounds, freeze/float/exit and refund rules, used as the illustration in Chapter 15.

Strategy, training plans and study frameworks are a synthesis of standard, publicly known CLAT preparation practice; they are opinion built on the official facts, not Consortium publications. Where a figure is an estimate (UG seat count, question-type shares), the text says so. The five practice passages in Chapter 20 are original illustrations written for this book in the exam's style — they are practice material, not past-paper questions. For anything that changes after printing — admit card dates, counselling calendars, centre updates — the Consortium website is the binding source.

Final word

Seventy-three days is 175 hours of awake, deliberate work. The field is 72,000 strong, but only a fraction of them will train reading deliberately, analyse mocks at 3:1, respect the scoring math, and sleep properly before December 6. Decide now that you will be in that fraction — then let the plan carry you.